

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3
 ♥ 5 4
 ♦ Q 10 8 3
 ♣ J 9 6 5 2

♠ 8 5
 ♥ A K Q 8 7 2
 ♦ K 5 4
 ♣ A Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K Q 10 7
 ♥ 10 9
 ♦ 9 7 2
 ♣ K 8 4

♠ J 6 4 2
 ♥ J 6 3
 ♦ A J 6
 ♣ 10 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	1 ♠	2 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♠ A			

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ A, West plays the ♠ 9, North the ♠ 5. You assume West has signaled you to continue ♠s, so you play the ♠ Q. On this trick West plays the ♠ 3 and North the ♠ 8. How will you continue?

You know that both West and North are now void of ♠s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠ Q, West won't bother ruffing, North **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠ J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠. West will ruff and North will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of South's ♠ J. As you can see, North would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠ J if you hadn't played this way.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 3
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥Q

played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

[showcards S:DJ W:D2 N:D4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and South won the ♥A.

South now plays the ♦J on which West plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when South plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

North hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the North hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that South plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what West plays. On the ♦J West

This defense holds South to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 7 2
 ♥ J 9 5 2
 ♦ A 8 4 3
 ♣ 8 3

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J 10 9

♣ A K Q J



♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 10 6 4

♦ K 7 2

♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 9 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

Lead: ♥4

win 2 ♥s, 2 ♦s and the ♠A, down 1

[showcards S:ST]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, West plays the ♥J, won by North with ♥A.

North plays the ♠J, you follow with ♠5, dummy ♠3 and West plays the ♠2. North continues with the ♠10

Play the ♠6.

West's ♠2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠s, obviously 3. Since North also must have 3, you must take your ♠A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

North may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out North's ♥K. You will

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ A 8 7 5 2
♦ 7 5 2
♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6
♥ J 10 6 3
♦ A Q 6
♣ Q 10 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 3 2
♥ -
♦ 10 9 8 4 3
♣ A K J 9

♠ A Q 10 5
♥ K Q 9 4
♦ K J
♣ 8 7 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT

Pass	3NT
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All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥5

♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

[showcards W:H5 N:HT]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

You really want West to lead a ♣ if he gets into the lead. If you discard the ♣9 West will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

South is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the

dummy and you now discard the ♠2. West takes the

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8
♥ A 10 9 7 6 3
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A 6 2

♠ A Q 10 9 4 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A K

♣ Q 8



♠ 6 5 3

♥ 4

♦ J 8 6 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ Q J 2

♦ Q 10 3

♣ K 10 7 5

West

2♥

Pass

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♥4

North

2♠

4♠

East

Pass

South

3♠

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, West takes the ♥A and returns the ♥3. You ruff and then play what???

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥3, a low card, for you to ruff. That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.